



PROGRESS REPORT

Data protection: progress report, 2025-09-01 to 2026-09-01

Edition of 2026-09-01 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

3 places. Every table below is carried verbatim from that place's own progress report; nothing is written here.

AFRICA · SOUTHERN AFRICA · WEST AFRICA

Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

Africa

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-01	MOVEMENT
Signatures and ratifications of the Malabo Convention	21 of 55 signed, 20 ratified or acceded and 20 deposited (2026-02-02, the depositary's register)	Equatorial Guinea, where the Convention was adopted and after whose then-capital it is named, signed on 2026-07-28 and has not deposited an instrument of ratification	ADVANCED, MARGINAL
Malabo Convention	In force, and the continental benchmark against which national data-protection regimes are measured	Unchanged in text; a majority of the Union's 55 members remain outside it twelve years after adoption	NO CHANGE
African Union Data Policy Framework	Baseline not held	In force as the continental reference framework, with about a third of the 54 member states aligned to it on a 2026-08-11 analysis, and 25 national regulatory sandboxes recorded across 15 countries by late 2024; no compliance mechanism, reporting cycle or enforcement route is stated	BASELINE NOT HELD

Southern Africa

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-01	MOVEMENT
SADC Data Protection Model Law	The 2012 model law, unrevised, with a modernisation consultancy tendered February 2022	Unchanged; no revised text and no outcome of the 2022 revision on record	NO CHANGE

West Africa

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-09-01	AT 2026-09-01	MOVEMENT
ECOWAS Supplementary Act on the Protection of Personal Data	The Supplementary Act of February 2010, the regional benchmark national bills were still being drafted against	A revised Act adopted; its text is not published with the communique, so what changed against 2010 is not establishable from the base; the complete text is now held, adopted at the thirty-seventh session of the Authority of Heads of State and Government in Abuja on 16 February 2010	ADVANCED

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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Figures are dated because most are time-varying: a figure carries the date it was true, not the date you are reading it. Where the base holds no reliable statement, the document says **Not held** rather than leaving a silence — those are counted, and listed at the end.

This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.